

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 41

By Yarbro

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of John Richard "Dick" Lodge, Jr.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of John Richard "Dick" Lodge, Jr., a former public servant in this great State and in Washington, D.C.; and

WHEREAS, Dick Lodge was a distinguished attorney for forty-seven years, a forty-two-year member of the Lodge Manufacturing Company Board of Directors in South Pittsburg, a member and officer of the University of the South's Board of Regents, and a consummate government relations professional and friend to many on Capitol Hill; and

WHEREAS, born in Sewanee on June 16, 1949, Mr. Lodge was the son of Reverend John Richard Lodge and Sarah Virginia "Pat" Lodge; he moved with his family a great deal in his youth, from Tennessee to Alabama to Alaska, ultimately graduating from Escambia County High School in Atmore, Alabama; and

WHEREAS, after graduating from the University of the South at Sewanee in 1971, he earned his Juris Doctor degree from Vanderbilt University School of Law in 1974, thereafter joining the legal team of Tennessee Attorney General R.A. Ashley for two years; he later resigned from that position to join the fledgling, yet ultimately successful, campaign of U.S. Senator Jim Sasser, who was elected to Congress in 1976; and

WHEREAS, Dick Lodge moved to Washington, D.C., as Senator Sasser's first Director of Legislation, a fortuitous endeavor in that it was there that he met his future wife, Gina, who was working for another freshman, Senator Patrick Moynihan of New York; and

WHEREAS, Dick and Gina married in 1978 and returned to Nashville, where Mr. Lodge joined the law firm of Willis and Knight; during his tenure as a young lawyer in Nashville, he became well known for his culinary skills involving all manner of cast iron cookware made by his

family's business in South Pittsburg, owing much to his family's background for generations in the cast iron skillet business along with Gina's hearty encouragement; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Lodge was elected to serve as the statewide Democratic Party Chair in 1983; during his five-year tenure, he headed the committee of Southern States to create Super Tuesday; at the urging of former Lt. Governor Frank Gorrell, he moved his legal practice to become a partner at the firm of Bass, Berry & Sims, chairing the Government Relations Practice area; and

WHEREAS, concurrently with his work at the law firm for thirty-three years, he remained interested and active in State and local government functions, leading to his appointment by Mayor Phil Bredesen as the first Chairman of Nashville's new Sports Authority in 1995; his leadership talents and gifts manifested in his church work and community service, with him serving as Senior Warden at Christ Church Cathedral, President of Legal Services of Middle Tennessee, and a legal and business advisor to Thistle Farms; and

WHEREAS, he was dedicated to mentoring young lawyers, young political leaders, and spiritual leaders destined for prominence in the Episcopal Church; while his forceful strength of advocacy was to be admired, he offered never-ending quiet kindnesses to those needing help; and

WHEREAS, above all, Dick Lodge was wholly devoted to his friends and his family, always endeavoring to remain true and loyal to those he loved; and

WHEREAS, he is survived by his beloved wife of forty-six years, Virginia "Gina" Tyler Lodge, former Tennessee Commissioner of Human Services for eight years; his children, Sarah Lodge (Trey) Tally and Richard Matthew (Rachael) Lodge; his grandchildren, Virginia Frances Tally, Earl Burton "E.B." Tally IV, John Richard "Jack" Lodge II, and Josephine Bright Lodge; his siblings, David (Andrea) Lodge, Sarah A. Lodge, and Henry (Donna) Lodge; and many nephews, nieces, great-nephews, and great-nieces; and

WHEREAS, Dick Lodge was a man of courage and honor in his business dealings as well as in his private life, and his friendship was a blessing to all who had the good fortune of knowing him; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Lodge leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life and compassion and loyalty in private life, living life with diligence and dedication to all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember and honor the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of John Richard "Dick" Lodge, Jr., extending our sympathy and offering our condolences to his many loved ones.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.